

SAMET APAYDIN

samet.apaydin@sabanciuniv.edu — linkedin.com/in/samet-apaydin

EDUCATION

Sabancı University	Istanbul, Turkey
Ph.D. in Political Science	2020 – 2025
◊ Dissertation: Between Gaps and Backlashes: Unpacking Türkiye’s Migration Governance and Domestic Implications • Committee: Meltem Müftüler-Baç (Advisor), Mert Moral, Kerim Can Kavaklı, Gerasimos Tsourapas, Ayşen Üstübeci	
University of Glasgow	Glasgow, Scotland
Visiting Ph.D. Researcher	2024 – 2025
Sabancı University	Istanbul, Turkey
M.A. in Political Science	2018 – 2020
◊ Thesis: The Role of Refugee Flows and Porous Borders in Shaping Voting Behavior	
Marmara University	Istanbul, Turkey
B.A. in Political Science and International Relations	2013 – 2018

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Postdoctoral Researcher	September 2025 – Present
Sabancı University	
Research Assistant	April 2024 – March 2025
University of Glasgow	
Research Assistant	July 2019 – August 2025
Sabancı University	

PUBLICATIONS

- The Syrian Refugee Crisis Through the Lenses of Turkish Political Discourses. **Samet Apaydin** and Meltem Müftüler-Baç. *International Migration*, 60(5): 217–236, 2022.

SELECTED WORKING PAPERS

- Immigration, Housing Markets, and Electoral Outcomes: Evidence from a Dispersal Policy in Türkiye. *Job Market Paper*.
- Understanding the International Politics of Return Diplomacy via QCA. Gerasimos Tsourapas, Zeynep Şahin-Mencütek, and **Samet Apaydin**. *Under Review*.
- Migration Diplomacy and Electoral Behavior: Survey Evidence from Türkiye.
- Evolving Migration Governance: Türkiye’s Policy Responses to Changing Trends. Book chapter, Hart Publishing. *Forthcoming*.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Securitization without Security: How Migration is Shaping the Global Order (SWS)	2025 – Present
Research Assistant, Mediterranean Team	Leir Institute for Migration and Human Security
– Collected, processed, and visualised data on irregular migration routes and nationalities, contributing to the development of spatial indicators and maps. – Conducted web-based data collection and monitoring to identify emerging trends and short- to medium-term changes in irregular migration dynamics.	

- Carried out fieldwork with local stakeholders and authorities to contextualise quantitative patterns and assess potential future developments.

Decentring the Study of Migrant Returns and Return Policies (GAPs)

2024 – 2025

Consortium Member

Horizon Europe

- Collected and systematised qualitative and quantitative data on return migration policies and practices across EU member states and third countries, supporting comparative indicator development.
- Applied mixed methods to analyse patterns of return migration diplomacy and cooperation outcomes across cases.
- Contributed to the organisation of academic workshops with a focus on policy-relevant research questions on return migration.

Measuring Irregular Migration (MirreM)

2023 – 2024

Country Expert, Türkiye

Horizon Europe

- Collected, systematised, and analysed country-level information on Türkiye's legal, policy, and institutional framework on irregular migration.
- Assessed the production, use, and limitations of irregular migration data from public authorities, service providers, and media sources, identifying key data gaps.
- Prepared internal analytical country profiles and publishable country briefs, integrating qualitative policy analysis with validated quantitative and mapped data.

Migration Governance and Asylum Crisis (MAGYC)

2020 – 2023

Consortium Member

Horizon Europe

- Analysed parliamentary deliberations in Türkiye, including official statements, committee discussions, and parliamentary questions on migration, asylum, and refugee policies.
- Traced legislative priorities, framing strategies, and patterns of political contestation across parties over time, identifying shifts in migration governance debates.
- Examined how domestic refugee dynamics, political pressures, and institutional constraints shaped Türkiye's external migration diplomacy and engagement with European and international partners.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

International Relations (IR 201)

Fall 2025

Instructor

Sabancı University

Quantitative Research Methods (POLS 530)

Spring 2021

Teaching Assistant

Sabancı University

- Graded weekly problem sets in STATA and quantitative methods.
- Held weekly office hours to assist students with STATA and course material.
- Advised students on final papers, including theory and research design.

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- **Understanding the International Politics of Return Diplomacy via Qualitative Comparative Analysis.** *IMISCOE Spring Conference*, Krems, Austria (Online), 2025.
- **Migration Diplomacy and Electoral Behavior in Türkiye.** *International Studies Association (ISA) Annual Convention*, San Francisco, 2024.
- **Formal and Informal Dimensions of Turkish Migration Governance: Linkages between Domestic and Transnational Politics.** *Migration Governance and Asylum Crises (MAGYC)*, Sciences Po, Centre de recherches internationales (CERI), 2023.
- **Assessing Turkish Parliamentary Deliberations on the Syrian Migration Crisis.** *PIC Lab Workshop*, Identity and Conflict Lab, University of Pennsylvania (Online), 2021.

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

- Reviewer for *International Migration*, *Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies*, *Turkish Studies*
- Editorial Assistant, *Migration Studies* (OUP)
- Communication Officer at Ethnicity, Nationalism, & Migration Studies (ENMISA) Section, International Studies Association (ISA)

NON-ACADEMIC POSITION

National Consultant

September 2025 – October 2025

Policy and Operations Evaluation Department (IOB)

Dutch Ministry of Foreign Affairs

- Conducted an independent policy evaluation through in-country fieldwork in Türkiye, including semi-structured interviews with national authorities, international organisations, and other relevant stakeholders.
- Built and analysed an integrated qualitative and quantitative evidence base drawing on interviews, focus groups, project documentation, and relevant policy and academic sources.
- Synthesised and triangulated evidence to assess project design, implementation, and outcomes against stated objectives, and drafted an analytical evaluation report delivering policy-relevant conclusions.

SKILLS

- **Languages:** Turkish (native), English (fluent)
- **Methods:** Causal inference (difference-in-differences, matching), survey and panel data analysis, spatial analysis and data visualization
- **Software:** Stata, R, Python, ArcGIS, L^AT_EX

REFERENCES

Available upon request.